

Water Safety Unit

Assessment Gradebook

Year 7–8 HPE · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · Safety Focus Area

[A–E Rubric](#)[Curriculum Codes](#)[Report Comment Generator](#)[Class Tracker](#)

Assessment Rubric — Water Safety Unit

Assessment Tasks Overview

This rubric applies to the two summative assessment tasks in the unit:

- Task 1 (40%):** Student Workbook — completed across all 5 lessons, collected end of unit
- Task 2 (60%):** Water Safety Communication Campaign — social media post, letter, or fact sheet

Note: Adjust weighting to suit your school's reporting requirements. Formative data (exit tickets, role-play observations) informs teacher feedback but is not formally graded.

E — Emerging**D — Developing****C — Consolidating****B — Building****A — Extending**

Criteria	E — Emerging	D — Developing	C — Consolidating	B — Building	A — Extending
Hazard Identification (VC2HP8P10)	Names one or two hazards with limited accuracy; relies on general or obvious examples only	Names several hazards; some accurate; minimal explanation of why each is dangerous	Accurately identifies key hazards in given environments; provides brief explanation for most	Accurately identifies multiple hazards across different environments; explains each clearly with reference to context	Systematically identifies and ranks hazards by risk level; explains specific mechanisms of danger with reference to evidence (e.g. Victorian data or physiological effects)
Water Safety Knowledge (VC2HP8P10)	Demonstrates minimal knowledge; responses are vague or inaccurate; unable to describe beach flags or DRS ABCD correctly	Demonstrates basic knowledge of some safety rules; some errors in DRS ABCD or flag identification	Demonstrates sound knowledge of beach flags, DRS ABCD, and SwimSafe rules; mostly accurate	Demonstrates thorough knowledge; accurately applies safety knowledge to different environments (beach, river, pool)	Demonstrates comprehensive, accurate knowledge; connects knowledge to broader prevention principles and Victorian context; uses specific terminology correctly
Application to Scenarios (VC2HP8P08, VC2HP8P10)	Responses are superficial or incorrect; does not apply safety knowledge appropriately to scenarios	Applies some correct steps to scenarios; significant gaps in logical reasoning; some unsafe decisions remain unjustified	Applies correct safety procedures to most scenarios; reasoning is generally sound; some gaps	Consistently applies correct safety procedures; justifies decisions clearly; identifies multiple risk factors per scenario	Applies and justifies safety decisions with precision; anticipates secondary risks; proposes nuanced solutions; shows genuine critical thinking about tradeoffs

Decision-Making & Peer Pressure (VC2HP8P08)	Does not identify peer pressure as a factor; unable to propose a strategy for resisting unsafe decisions	Identifies peer pressure as a factor; proposes a basic strategy with limited detail or realistic application	Explains how peer pressure influences water safety decisions; describes a realistic strategy for managing peer pressure	Analyses peer pressure in context; proposes specific, realistic strategies with clear justification; connects to personal experience	Demonstrates sophisticated understanding of social factors influencing risk decisions near water; proposes multiple strategies; considers cultural and gender factors with evidence support
Emergency Response (VC2HP8P10)	Unable to describe DRS ABCD correctly; does not understand throw rescue principle	Describes some DRS ABCD steps; errors or omissions in sequence; partial understanding of rescue safety	Describes DRS ABCD in correct order with reasonable accuracy; understands "throw, don't go" principle	Accurately describes and applies DRS ABCD in scenario contexts; explains throw rescue with specifics; understands when to call 000	Demonstrates thorough mastery of emergency response; applies DRS ABCD to complex scenarios; articulates rationale for each step; understands CPR physiology and AED use
Communication Campaign Task (VC2HP8P10)	Incomplete or very brief; message is unclear; audience not considered; no accurate data used	Attempts an appropriate format; message is mostly clear; some relevant safety information; limited use of data	Clear message appropriate for chosen audience; includes at least one accurate statistic; communicates effectively	Compelling, well-structured message clearly targeting chosen audience; accurate statistics used effectively; includes a clear call to action	Professional-quality communication; audience-specific language and design; multiple accurate statistics with source attribution; persuasive and evidence-based call to action
Personal Action Plan (VC2HP8P10)	Generic or incomplete plan; "I will be careful" type responses; lacks specificity	Some personal commitment evident; at least one specific safety rule identified; limited connection to own life	Specific, realistic commitments to personal water safety; shows connection between knowledge and own behaviour	Thoughtful, personalised action plan; multiple specific commitments; shows genuine reflection on own habits and risk contexts	Comprehensive action plan reflecting sophisticated self-awareness; considers both personal and community responsibility; demonstrates transfer of learning to real life

Formative Assessment Checklist (Lessons 1–4)

Record observations during class. These are not formally graded but inform feedback and identify students who need support.

Observable Behaviour	Lesson	Note if: concern / developing / confident
Can identify 5+ water hazards independently	L1	<i>Teacher observation</i>
Correctly identifies all 6 beach flags	L2	<i>Workbook 2.1</i>
Describes rip current escape correctly	L2	<i>Workbook 2.2</i>
Recalls DRS ABCD without prompt	L3	<i>Opening activity</i>
Physically demonstrates throw rescue	L3	<i>Practical observation</i>
Articulates peer pressure strategy convincingly	L4	<i>Discussion / Q 4.1a</i>
Can explain cold water shock effects	L4	<i>Workbook 5.1</i>

